

The Secret Santa Murder

An Office Christmas Party Murder Mystery Game



❄️ What it is

A printable, team-based mystery game set at the holiday party of a fictional gift-basket company. Colleagues work in detective teams to work out who tampered with a Secret Santa gift, using printed evidence cards, short role booklets and conversation. It is an icebreaker and a team-building activity in one.

GROUP SIZE

8–40 players. 8–10 play individually; 11–40 play in 3–6 teams of up to 8.

TWO LENGTHS

Full Party: 2–2.5 hours.

Lunch-Hour Express: 60–75 minutes.

❄️ Content rating: PG

No gore, no romance, no drinking requirements and no adult content. No jokes about real people, jobs, appearance, gender, ethnicity or religion. The story's motives are money, credit for ideas and promotions. All names and companies are fictional.

❄️ Inclusion

- All roles are gender-neutral; materials use names, not he/she.
- Nobody is required to perform. Up to 10 people volunteer for speaking roles; everyone else joins a detective team.
- Quiet colleagues take part through a personal guest card and team discussion.
- Works seated at tables; accessible rooms and dietary needs are easy to plan around.

WHAT WE NEED

- Office printing: about 61–96 pages, black and white is fine
- Scissors and pens
- Optional: microphone or speaker
- Optional: 2–3 volunteer helpers

SUGGESTED BUDGET LINES

- Game download: one-time purchase
- Snacks and non-alcoholic drinks
- Optional: small prizes for the winning team
- Optional: card stock for name tags

WHY THIS GAME

Designed for workplaces: built for teams, scales from 8 to 40, runs in an hour or an afternoon, and needs no acting or costumes (a scarf or a festive hat is plenty).